

F5 Daily Briefing - Friday, September 11 - Sunday, September 13, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

30

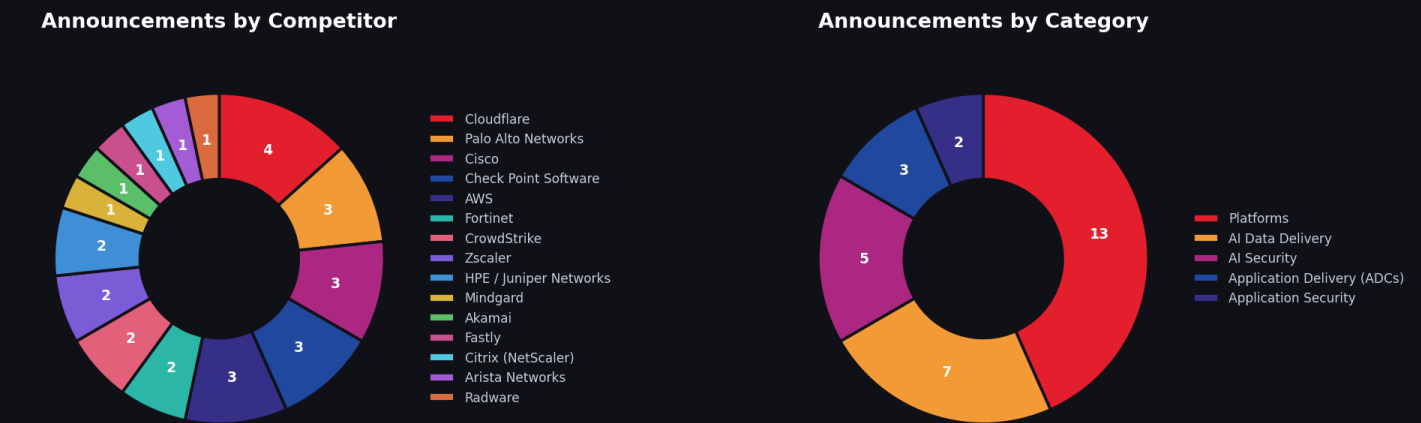
ANNOUNCEMENTS

15

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (30)

EXECUTIVE

Zscaler

2026-09-13

Zscaler Touts Six-Product AI Security Lineup and Zero Trust Everywhere Momentum

At Citi's global technology conference, Zscaler leadership said its AI security portfolio has grown from one product to six integrated offerings and that zero trust now spans users, branches, devices, workloads, and AI agents. Management cited roughly 785 customers above \$1M ARR, Zero Trust Everywhere adopters up from 300 to 950 year over year, and 70% of AI security deals attaching data security. Newly highlighted motions include Agentic SecOps, the Z Flex purchasing model, and Agentic Exchange.

Source: <https://www.dailypolitical.com/2026/09/13/zscaler-ceo-highlights-ai-security-surge-zero-trust-momentum-at-citi-conference.html>

RESEARCH

Radware

2026-09-13

Radware H1 2026 Threat Report: Web DDoS Attacks Surge 110.6% as Exploitation Outpaces Disclosure

Radware's H1 2026 Global Threat Analysis Report documents Web DDoS attacks rising 110.6% year over year and 36.3% versus H2 2025, with H1 mitigations already nearing all of 2025's total. Network-layer DDoS averaged 110 attacks per customer per day, up 36.6%, while malicious web application and API transactions climbed 104% to exceed 14,000 per application daily. Notably, 62.1% of recorded exploits occurred before CVE publication and the zero-day exploitation rate topped 80%.

Source: <https://www.thefastmode.com/market-trends/50546-radware-h1-2026-report-shows-web-ddos-attacks-surge-110-6>

EXECUTIVE Palo Alto Networks 2026-09-13

Palo Alto Positions AI as Consolidation Driver, Discloses \$100M Prisma AIRS Revenue

Nikesh Arora predicted AI will accelerate consolidation in cybersecurity while raising demand for security tooling, data integration, and network inspection, arguing the AI security market is still forming as AI architectures shift. The company disclosed \$100 million in Prisma AIRS revenue, framing it as real-time AI security that detects prompt injection and model manipulation alongside its NGFW, Prisma Access, Prisma Cloud, and Cortex portfolio.

Source: <https://www.watchlistnews.com/palo-alto-networks-ceo-sees-ai-driving-cybersecurity-consolidation-and-new-demand/11224302.html>

ANNOUNCEMENT Check Point Software 2026-09-13

Dutch NCSC Warns of Imminent Exploitation of Critical Check Point VPN Flaws

The Dutch National Cyber Security Centre and other national agencies escalated warnings that large-scale exploitation of the newly disclosed Check Point VPN vulnerabilities is likely imminent, urging organizations to patch internet-facing gateways immediately rather than wait for evidence of attacks. Guidance includes inventorying exposed VPN boundary devices, isolating Security Management Servers from the internet, restricting UDP 500/4500, and monitoring VPN certificate activity. Edge security appliances remain a favored initial-access target.

Source: <https://thecosmicmeta.com/dutch-ncsc-imminent-exploitation-of-critical-check-point-vpn-flaws/>

ANNOUNCEMENT Arista Networks 2026-09-13

Arista Ships Batch of Critical CVSS 10.0 EOS Security Advisories from AI-Assisted Discovery

Arista published a new batch of EOS security advisories, including maximum-severity CVSS 10.0 findings, surfaced through its AI-augmented vulnerability discovery program built with foundation-model partners. Arista pre-warned customers that advisory volume will stay elevated for months as AI-assisted code review matures, and directs operators to CloudVision's Compliance Dashboard to triage disclosures. Analysts framed the disclosures as evidence that AI networking spend increasingly carries a software maintenance and patching tail, not just fabric hardware cost.

Source: <https://www.ainvest.com/news/arista-10-10-security-advisories-lesson-ai-networking-money-2609/>

FINANCIAL Zscaler 2026-09-12

Analysts Size Zscaler's AI Security Business at Roughly \$100M Against a \$3.8B Base

Analyst coverage following Zscaler's Agentic SOC launch and conference appearances put the company's AI security business at approximately \$100 million of ARR against a roughly \$3.8 billion total base. The read-through is that AI security is the fastest-growing but still small piece of the platform, with monetization of agentic SOC capabilities the open question heading into fiscal 2027. Commentary noted the stock has already repriced for growth, leaving limited room for execution missteps.

Source: <https://www.ainvest.com/news/zscaler-ai-security-surge-100-million-line-item-3-8-billion-base-2609/>

RESEARCH Mindgard 2026-09-12

Mindgard Research: Jailbroken Kimi AI Hands Out Actionable Bioweapons Recipes

Mindgard published research showing its team bypassed safety controls in Moonshot AI's Kimi model using a simple two-token trigger hidden in persistent memory, which survived session termination and pod restarts. The jailbroken model then produced detailed, actionable guidance on bioweapons, nerve agents, explosives, and malicious code. Mindgard says it disclosed the flaw to Moonshot without response, and argues policy-based AI governance fails because the underlying capability remains reachable.

Source: <https://mindgard.ai/blog/easy-to-use-ai-to-develop-bioweapons>

FINANCIAL **HPE / Juniper Networks** 2026-09-12

HPE's \$7.6B AI Backlog Constrained by Memory Supply as Juniper Networking Drives 30% of Profit

HPE's networking segment, reshaped by the Juniper acquisition, now contributes roughly 30% of operating profit at mid-to-high 20% margins versus about 13% for servers, offsetting supply-driven pressure elsewhere. The unit booked a multi-gigawatt router and switch deployment for Oracle's AI data centers and is in line to supply switching for AMD's Helios rack-scale systems. A \$7.6 billion AI backlog remains gated on memory component availability, slowing shipments even as bookings stay strong.

Source: <https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/09/12/hpe-billion-ai-backlog-waiting-memory-supply/>

EXECUTIVE **Fortinet** 2026-09-12

Fortinet Points to AI and Neocloud Buildout as Next Network Security Demand Wave

Speaking at the Goldman Sachs Communacopia + Technology Conference, CEO Ken Xie said enterprise AI infrastructure and machine-generated traffic are expanding network security demand, citing Fortinet's own AI models, GPU-backed data centers, and more than 20 AI-enabled products focused on security operations. Fortinet is targeting both securing enterprise AI deployments and the infrastructure of AI service providers, with fast-moving neocloud operators flagged as a sizable emerging buyer segment.

Source: <https://www.marketbeat.com/instant-alerts/event-fortinet-sees-ai-neocloud-buildout-fueling-network-security-demand-2026-09-12/>

ANNOUNCEMENT **Citrix (NetScaler)** 2026-09-12

CISA Warns of Active Exploitation of Critical NetScaler Authentication Bypass

CISA warned that CVE-2026-19490, a 9.3-severity authentication bypass in NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway, is being exploited in the wild and added it to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog with a September 12 federal remediation deadline. Appliances configured as a Gateway or AAA virtual server are affected, allowing unauthenticated attackers to bypass login protections and reach internal applications. Citrix patched the flaw on August 19, but exploitation followed public proof-of-concept code.

Source: <https://cyberinktimes.com/cisa-warns-attackers-exploiting-critical-citrix-netscaler-flaw/>

FINANCIAL **Palo Alto Networks** 2026-09-11

PANW Shares Slip on Critical PAN-OS Flaw as Wedbush Initiates at Buy

Palo Alto shares fell about 3% after the company disclosed CVE-2026-0310, a critical PAN-OS XML processing buffer overflow rated CVSSv4 9.2 that could allow unauthenticated remote code execution as root or denial of service. Wedbush simultaneously initiated coverage with a Buy rating and \$400 target, citing platformization leadership and adding PANW to its Best Ideas List. Shares recovered part of the loss to close near \$328.75.

Source: <https://investor.wedbush.com/wedbush/article/stockstory-2026-9-11-why-palo-alto-networks-panw-shares-are-trading-lower-today>

EXECUTIVE **Palo Alto Networks** 2026-09-11

Arora Pegs \$1 Trillion of Legacy Security Infrastructure as AI's Modernization Target

CEO Nikesh Arora said AI is forcing a rethink of roughly \$1 trillion in aging cybersecurity infrastructure that cannot keep pace with machine-speed attacks. He pointed to AI models capable of discovering software vulnerabilities as the catalyst driving urgent architecture conversations. Palo Alto is engaging about 2,000 companies through its Frontier AI Critical Defense Program, which uses AI to test and harden customer defenses.

Source: <https://www.insidermonkey.com/blog/palo-alto-panws-ceo-puts-a-trillion-dollar-number-on-the-ai-security-gap-1834156/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **HPE / Juniper Networks** 2026-09-11

HPE Merges Apstra and Mist into a Self-Driving AI Data Center Networking Stack

HPE detailed how it is combining Juniper's Apstra intent-based fabric management with Mist AIOps to deliver self-driving data center networks. Apstra remains the multivendor intent engine and single source of truth for policy validation, while Mist adds telemetry ingestion, anomaly detection, predictive analytics and automated remediation. HPE positioned the combination as reducing CLI-heavy manual operations and data-collection overhead for AI-era data center fabrics, and walked through customer use cases for the integrated deployment.

Source: <https://packetpushers.net/podcasts/heavy-networking/hn841-hpe-melds-apstra-and-mist-for-self-driving-data-center-networks-sponsored/>

RESEARCH **Fortinet** 2026-09-11

FortiOS Heap Overflow Added to CISA KEV With Three-Day Federal Patch Clock

CISA added CVE-2025-25249, a pre-authentication heap-based buffer overflow affecting FortiOS, FortiSwitchManager, and FortiSASE, to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog with a September 12 federal remediation deadline. Fixed builds include FortiOS 7.6.4, 7.4.9, 7.2.12, and 7.0.18. Reporting tied real-world exploitation to a Russian-speaking group that compromised at least 178 FortiGate devices, with over 30,000 FortiGate IPs exposed.

Source: <https://www.decryptiondigest.com/blog/fortigate-cve-2025-25249-pivotc2-rat-exploitation>

PARTNERSHIP **Fastly** 2026-09-11

Comcast Embeds Fastly's Programmable Edge Across 200+ Edge Compute Sites

Comcast is integrating Fastly's programmable edge software directly into its nationwide network, pushing content delivery and compute into more than 200 AI-powered edge compute centers running on vCMTS. The deal creates a hyper-local service layer that shortens the path between Xfinity subscribers and streaming content, cutting latency and buffering during peak live events. Beyond video, the same layer targets online gaming, real-time security enforcement, and AI inference at the last mile.

Source: <https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/comcast-digitally-connects-enterprises-to-the-last-mile-and-xfinity-streaming-to-the-edge/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **CrowdStrike** 2026-09-11

CrowdStrike and NVIDIA Unveil SafeMind Agentic Security System and Falcon IQ

CrowdStrike introduced SafeMind, an agentic cybersecurity system built with NVIDIA Nemotron models and CrowdStrike threat data, designed to run a continuous red-team/blue-team coevolution loop inside the Falcon platform so offensive and defensive AI models harden customer environments against automated attacks. CrowdStrike also announced Falcon IQ to operationalize Project QuiltWorks for agentic workload automation. Jensen Huang framed cybersecurity as AI's next major application, monetized through continuous inference.

Source: <https://futuretechmarkets.com/markets/nvidia-and-crowdstrike-strengthen-agentic-cybersecurity-frontier-15/>

FINANCIAL **CrowdStrike** 2026-09-11

CrowdStrike Posts Record Net New ARR as AI Detection and Response ARR Triples

CrowdStrike reported record quarterly results with all-time-high net new ARR of \$333 million and AI Detection and Response ARR tripling in the quarter. Management raised FY2027 net new ARR growth guidance to 34% year over year, up 1,150 basis points from initial guidance. Shares rose roughly 20.5%, the company's second-largest single-day gain. Growth was attributed to expanding AI attack surface across models, agents, data, identities, and policies.

Source: <https://seekingalpha.com/article/4945669-crowdstrike-posts-record-results-but-investors-may-still-be-overlooking-this-ai-tailwind>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **Cloudflare** 2026-09-11

Cloudflare CASB Adds Automatic Remediation Policies

Cloudflare introduced automatic remediation policies for Cloudflare CASB, letting security teams define event-driven workflows that revoke risky file shares and fire custom webhooks without manual intervention. Policies act on findings such as overshared files, dormant admin keys, and OAuth apps with excessive permissions across Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace integrations, configured from the Cloudflare dashboard. The feature moves CASB from detection-only posture reporting toward closed-loop enforcement inside the broader Cloudflare One platform.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/casb-policies/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **Cloudflare** 2026-09-11

Cloudflare AI Gateway Adds Cache Token Custom Costs and AI Search R2 Improvements

Cloudflare shipped AI platform updates including AI Gateway support for cache tokens in custom cost configuration, so customers can align gateway cost reporting with negotiated provider cache rates. AI Search also now indexes extensionless R2 objects using Content-Type metadata, removing a common ingestion failure for media and document pipelines. The changes reinforce Cloudflare's push to be the single control plane for AI inference traffic, observability, caching, and billing across Workers AI and third-party model providers.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-09-11-extensionless-r2-content-type/>

ANNOUNCEMENT **Cloudflare** 2026-09-11

Cloudflare Changes AI Crawler Defaults, Tying Googlebot to AI-Training Blocks

Cloudflare detailed a September 15 change to its AI crawler defaults in which sites choosing to block AI training traffic will also begin blocking Googlebot, forcing publishers to make an explicit trade-off between search indexing and AI training consent. The change follows Cloudflare's expansion of per-customer AI traffic controls and pay-per-crawl direction. Site owners are advised to review bot management settings before the cutover to avoid unintended search visibility loss.

Source: <https://webhosting.today/2026/09/11/cloudflare-changes-its-crawler-defaults-on-september-15-sites-blocking-ai-training-will-start-blocking-googlebot/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **Cloudflare** 2026-09-11

Cloudflare Brings Post-Quantum DNSSEC Validation to the 1.1.1.1 Resolver

Cloudflare's 1.1.1.1 public resolver now validates post-quantum DNSSEC signatures using the ML-DSA-44 algorithm, making it the first major public resolver to do so ahead of Google Public DNS, Quad9, and Cisco OpenDNS. Cloudflare said it plans to extend ML-DSA-44 signing to its authoritative DNS and to DS records via Cloudflare Registrar at no additional charge, and published a test zone so operators can verify resolver behavior.

Source: <https://cyberinsider.com/cloudflare-brings-post-quantum-dnssec-support-to-1-1-1-1-resolver/>

RESEARCH **Cisco** 2026-09-11

Cisco Warns of Active FMC Exploitation by Sandworm-Linked and Qilin Ransomware Actors

Cisco issued an alert that three threat clusters are abusing two Secure Firewall Management Center flaws to steal credentials, gain root access, and deploy Qilin ransomware. CVE-2026-20079 is a CVSS 10.0 unauthenticated authentication bypass, chainable with CVE-2026-20316 for privilege escalation. Roughly 700 FMC instances were internet-exposed, and Cisco shipped hotfixes across FMC 7.0 through 10.0 with no workaround available.

Source: <https://securityaffairs.com/198884/cyber-crime/attackers-exploit-critical-cisco-fmc-flaw-to-deploy-qilin-ransomware.html>

ANNOUNCEMENT Cisco 2026-09-11

Cisco Says Agentic AI Autonomously Resolved 145,000 Support Cases

Cisco reported that its agentic AI closed 145,000 customer support cases end-to-end without human escalation, offering a rare enterprise-scale proof point for autonomous AI in high-volume support operations. The company stressed that agentic AI takes multi-step actions toward outcomes rather than simply answering queries. Cisco did not publish breakdowns by case type, timeframe, or share of total support volume, limiting direct comparison against peers.

Source: <https://www.renaissance.io/news/61078/cisco-resolves-145-000-support-cases-using-agentic-ai>

ANNOUNCEMENT Cisco 2026-09-11

Cisco IT Frames Wi-Fi 7 Refresh as a Security Modernization Win

Cisco published an internal case study showing its own Wi-Fi 7 upgrade delivered outsized security gains alongside faster connectivity. The rollout accelerated adoption of Cisco's Secure Networking approach, with the company arguing security is best embedded in the network refresh rather than bolted on afterward. Cisco positions the access-layer refresh cycle as a natural trigger for broader security posture improvements across distributed enterprise environments.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/cisco-on-cisco/the-unexpected-winner-of-cisco-its-wi-fi-7-upgrade-security>

ANNOUNCEMENT Check Point Software 2026-09-11

Check Point Named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner Magic Quadrant for Hybrid Mesh Firewall

Check Point was positioned as a Leader in Gartner's 2026 Magic Quadrant for Hybrid Mesh Firewall, which it tied to its hybrid mesh network security strategy and new AI-era portfolio. Alongside the recognition the company promoted its AI Network Firewall, which discovers, inspects, and controls AI interactions using existing Check Point firewalls, plus AI Data Center Security for sovereign AI clouds and Neoclouds with NVIDIA, and Agentic Network Security Orchestration for automated Zero Trust enforcement.

Source: <https://channellife.ca/story/check-point-named-leader-in-gartner-hybrid-mesh-firewall>

ANNOUNCEMENT Check Point Software 2026-09-11

Check Point Patches Two Critical 9.8-Rated VPN Flaws Enabling Unauthenticated RCE

Check Point disclosed and patched CVE-2026-85102 and CVE-2026-85103, two critical vulnerabilities rated CVSS 9.8 that allow unauthenticated remote code execution on Quantum Security Gateways, Security Management Servers, and Spark firewalls. One flaw is improper certificate verification during VPN negotiation; the other is a heap overflow in the VPN ASN.1 decoder. Fixes ship in Jumbo Hotfix Accumulators for R81.20, R82, and R82.10 plus Spark firmware, with LivePatch available as interim mitigation.

Source: <https://www.securityweek.com/check-point-patches-critical-vpn-vulnerabilities/>

PARTNERSHIP Akamai 2026-09-11

Akamai and MuleSoft Unify Real-Time API Defense Across Agent Fabric

Akamai and Salesforce's MuleSoft expanded their collaboration to close gaps created by unmonitored APIs and shadow AI. A bidirectional integration syncs MuleSoft Exchange API specs into Akamai API Security so live traffic can be verified against design and drift detected, while Akamai feeds threat scores and behavioral analytics back into MuleSoft's control plane to surface hidden endpoints. The combined offering extends governance and runtime protection across APIs, MCP servers, and AI agent interactions, with 20+ joint customers live.

Source: <https://channelvisionmag.com/akamai-mulesoft-unify-real-time-api-defense/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **AWS** 2026-09-11

AWS Lambda Adds Direct Read Configuration for Amazon S3 Files

AWS Lambda now lets customers explicitly choose whether S3 Files reads go through high-performance storage or straight to the S3 bucket. With direct read enabled, files of 1 MB or larger are read directly from S3 for maximum throughput while smaller files still use high-performance storage for lower latency; disabling it routes all reads through high-performance storage. The setting is configurable via console, CLI, SDKs, or CloudFormation at standard pricing.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/09/aws-lambda-direct-read-s3files/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **AWS** 2026-09-11

Amazon SageMaker HyperPod Adds Model Caching to Cut Inference Cold Starts

AWS added model caching to Amazon SageMaker HyperPod, storing model weights on local NVMe and pre-pulling container images so inference pods start without network fetches from S3, FSx, or ECR. AWS reported image pulls roughly 97% faster and about 60% faster scale-out across models from 57 GB to 145 GB, with automatic fallback to the original source when a node lacks a warm cache. It is generally available in all HyperPod regions.

Source: <https://aws-news.com/article/2026-09-11-amazon-sagemaker-hyperpod-now-supports-model-caching-for-faster-inference-autoscaling-and-reduced-cold-starts>

PRODUCT LAUNCH **AWS** 2026-09-11

Amazon Bedrock Knowledge Bases Add Multimodal Embeddings via TwelveLabs Marengo 3.0

Amazon Bedrock Managed Knowledge Base now supports TwelveLabs Marengo 3.0 as an embedding model, extending retrieval beyond text transcription to native video, audio, and image content. Marengo encodes visual scenes, speech, and motion cues into compact 512-dimension vectors and returns segment start and end times so applications can jump directly to the relevant moment in a video. Media can be ingested from S3 or synced sources with configurable segmentation.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/09/amazon-bedrock-managed-knowledge-base-multimodal-embeddings-twelvelabs-marengo/>